

A studio operating system for BRENDA ARTS

You are currently the operating system for two full pipelines at once – making the film, and running the studio. Every piece of state lives in your head until you move it somewhere else. This is a map of the lanes where that can stop being true.

18

days to Counter of Sheep

12

lanes on the table

25

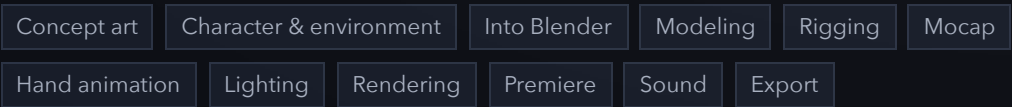
pipeline stages you hold in your head

WHAT I HEARD

Two pipelines. One person holding both.

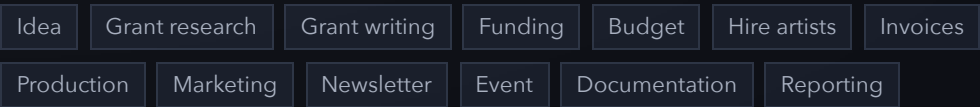
Neither workflow is unusual on its own. The friction is that you are the connective tissue between them – and that job has no off switch.

Creative – Counter of Sheep



Twelve stages. Every one produces assets that have to stay findable months later – for the edit, the grant report, and the pitch.

Studio – BRENDA ARTS



Thirteen stages. On its own this is an executive director's full-time job – and you are also the artist, the teacher, and the fundraiser.

One thing worth naming. When you described your work, you listed it by what felt most urgent – not chronologically, not by project. That isn't disorganization. That's a person holding a dependency graph in working memory. The system's job is to hold the graph so you can hold one thing at a time.

THE SHAPE OF IT

Not another app. A producer.

You open the laptop once. It already knows what today costs you.

Good morning, Spencer

THURSDAY · 14 DAYS TO OPENING

COUNTER OF SHEEP

●

Finish Scene 12 animation

4 hrs

●

Samantha invoice still pending

\$500

●

Table fabrication due

Thu

TODAY

●

PAM CUT

2:00 · leave 1:20

Bring: laptop · curriculum · budget

WAITING ON

●

Barry – Roundhouse curriculum

6 days

●

RACC – report confirmation

11 days

NETWORK

You met Mark Garcia 18 days ago. Follow up?

RENDERING

●

Counter_of_Sheep_v42.blend – 63%

done 3:12 PM

What makes this different

- It reads from the other lanes. Nothing here is typed twice.
- Ordered by consequence, not by category or date created.
- It answers "what did I promise that isn't done?" – the question that actually keeps you up.
- When the day breaks, it re-plans instead of guiltling you.

The rule the whole build follows

If a module needs you to maintain it, it's already dead. Capture is one gesture – say it, paste it, forward it. The system files. You never file.

NON-NEGOTIABLE

Your students' names, faces, and artwork stay on your machine. They are never sent to anyone's cloud model. Every other tool in this category ships everything off-device.

THE LANES

Twelve places we can take weight off you

You pick which ones turn on, and in what order. Nothing here requires all of it.

Eight things nobody put on your list

Ranked by what I think each is actually worth to you.

1 Impact data

Funders renew on numbers. You've run programs since 2019 and probably can't produce a clean count of students served, hours taught, or schools reached. That count is the difference between \$5,000 awards and six-figure ones – and it's the easiest thing here to start collecting.

3 Speaking as a revenue line

Treefort, Summer Games Fest, Nike HQ, OMSI, CreativeMornings. You're clearly good at it and there's no pipeline, no rate card, no follow-up. That's money you're already qualified for.

5 Contracts and a rate card

You're hiring at \$35/hr and working with minors. Contractor agreements, W-9s, release forms, work-for-hire language, and a written rate card. All cheap now, all expensive later.

7 Archive discipline

Samantha is documenting Aug 21–22. That footage is grant reporting, pitch material, and two years of content – if someone files it properly the first time.

2 Your website

brendaarts.org is live but it's a headline and three sentences. A stranger can't see a single frame of your work or figure out how to hire you. It's the first thing anyone checks after meeting you.

4 Curriculum as a product

You have years of tested lesson material. Museums and districts buy curriculum. One table serves one room – a licensed curriculum serves a state.

6 Render and asset infrastructure

The largest recoverable time sink for a solo animator: re-finding assets, re-rendering, versions that drift. Unglamorous, immediately felt.

8 Festival strategy

You've been in BlackStar. There's a whole circuit that leads to the exact buyers you want, and it runs entirely on deadlines nobody is tracking.

HOW WE'D DO IT

The exhibition comes first. Everything else waits.

There are 18 days until Counter of Sheep opens. Building a four-module system during the worst week of your year would be the wrong kind of help. So we build the one thing that gets you through August, and it quietly collects the data the rest needs anyway.



Honest about status

Some of this already runs – invoicing, contacts, the daily planner, the local AI. Some is adapted from work we've shipped. Some is genuinely new. We'll tell you which is which every time, and we won't demo anything as done that isn't.

You approve everything

Nothing auto-posts, auto-sends, or auto-submits. The system drafts and tracks; you decide. Reaching out to the internet is a thing it asks permission for, every time.

It runs on your machine

Student data, releases, contacts, and finances stay local. That's not a preference – with minors in your files it's the only defensible way to build this.

WHAT I NEED FROM YOU

Ten questions

Answer what you can. The ones you can't answer are usually the most interesting.

The record

- 1 The Nebraska residency – which institution, which program, which year, and what came out of it?
- 2 Adult Swim and Nickelodeon – credited work, freelance, a pitch, or development?
- 3 Netflix – who did you pitch, what did you pitch, and what was the actual objection they gave you?
- 4 Smithsonian and MoMA – where do those really stand today?
- 5 The RACC \$5,000 – what did it obligate you to deliver, and when is the report due?

Structure and reality

- 6 Is BRENDA ARTS LLC your only entity? Any fiscal sponsor? Any 501(c)(3) in progress?
- 7 Who holds copyright on student work – the island houses, the BRENDAWORLD rides, the Albina dreams? Do signed releases exist?
- 8 For Aug 21–22, what is genuinely not done – and what would you cut first if you had to cut something?
- 9 What are you in every day? And the exact name of the VR and mocap software you use.
- 10 If this only did one thing perfectly, what would you pick?

Two of these aren't really questions. **Number 6** – the RACC award was made to "Garland, Spencer," not to your LLC, and most foundation money can only reach a nonprofit or a fiscally sponsored artist. **Number 7** – unclear rights on student work is what stops a streaming or museum deal in the first week of legal review. Both are fixable right now and painful to fix later.

WHERE THIS GOES

You don't need a second brain. You need a producer for the next eighteen days —

and after that, a system that turns what you've already built — a film, a physical product line, a working education channel, a shipped game, a live audience — into something the industry has a box for.

Next

One call. The ten questions. No pitch — I want to see the real state of things before anyone builds anything.

Then

Run of Show in your hands around Aug 12, so it's broken in before the day it matters.

After the show

We pick two lanes. Not twelve. The ones where you're bleeding the most time.